

As we are already aware by now, web apps combine the best aspects of a web site and a simple desktop application. A web app is much more rich and interactive than a web site, but less cumbersome and monolithic than a desktop application. Many installable web apps are hosted apps – normal web sites with a bit of extra metadata. You can build and deploy hosted apps exactly as you would build and deploy any web app, using any server-side or client-side technology you prefer. The only difference is that you must provide a small manifest file that describes the app. More on that later.

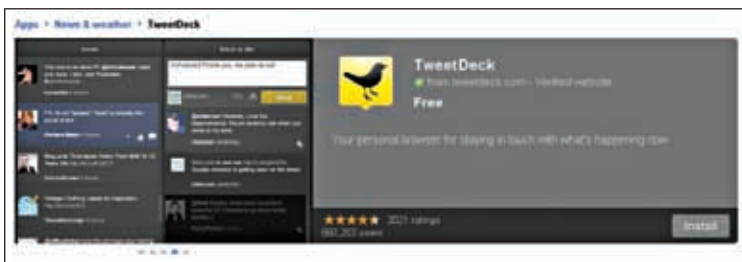
If you want your app to work especially well offline or to be tightly integrated with the Google Chrome browser, you can create a packaged app. A packaged app is just a web app that a user downloads. These apps have the option of using the Google Chrome Extension APIs, allowing them to change the way Chrome behaves or looks.

Hosted apps

If you already have a web app and are unwilling to tweak around with it, you can just publish it as a hosted app. A hosted app requires a CRX



Hosted App: Google Books is a hosted app



Packaged App: TweetDeck is a very popular packaged app